

POSSIBLE FUTURES

Exploring Humanity's Possible Futures
in the Age of Artificial Intelligence

INTRODUCTION

START EXPLORING →

WHY POSSIBLE FUTURES?

Opening context

Only a few years ago, many of the ideas presented here would have sounded like pure science fiction (Her, Irobot, Terminator, ...), or the fantasies of a paranoid conspiracy theorist.

Yet the exponential progress of Artificial Intelligence over the last two years is forcing us to **revisit assumptions that once seemed unquestionable**:

Assumptions under pressure

- | | | |
|----|----------------------------|--|
| 01 | Human intelligence | As the dominant form of intelligence on Earth |
| 02 | Human work | As the foundation of our economies and a key pillar of our societies |
| 03 | Human relationships | As the fabric that holds societies together |

Two major concerns

01 The concentration of power

A small number of individuals, companies and governments aim to gain an unprecedented advantage over the rest of humanity.

02 The increasing probability of losing control

We are collectively embracing a technological revolution whose long-term consequences for humanity remain deeply uncertain.

What disturbs me: Rest of the humanity is the missing voice

The future of humanity is increasingly being shaped by decisions taken today by a surprisingly small number of actors.

Yet the consequences could affect everyone: our children, siblings, parents, friends, neighbors, colleagues, and future generations.

Finding this situation unacceptable and seeing both the lack of public awareness and the widespread indifference surrounding these issues, I decided to bring together information collected over time in a single place, with the goal of raising awareness, encouraging reflection, and fostering discussion.

A global conversation is urgently needed to determine where we collectively place the cursor on the pace and objectives of AI development, rather than allowing a handful of powerful individuals to decide on behalf of humanity and primarily in pursuit of their own interests.

Author position:

YES to AI and progress. **NO** to recklessness, concentration of power and wealth, and gambling with humanity's future.

ABOUT THIS WORK

A personal exploration

Possible Futures is a personal exploration built from a wide range of sources, including podcasts such as **Sismique**, **Comptoir IA**, **Dwarkesh**, **Le Futurologue**, **Esprit IA**, **Perspectives IA**, and many hours of personal reflection.

It does not claim to predict the future.

Its purpose is simply to explore possible futures, challenge assumptions, and **encourage discussion about the choices humanity may soon face.**

I hope you will find this exploration useful.

Your feedback, questions and challenges are always welcome.

Security Notice

This PDF contains navigation links for internal document browsing only (Home, Glossary, Conclusions, Scenarios, etc.). No hyperlinks to external websites, downloadable files, scripts or third-party content are embedded in this document. The document has been verified prior to publication.

Notes

All illustrations were generated using Gemini - Nano Banana 2.

Most of the text and ideas were challenged using AI tools in order to improve clarity, consistency and the understanding of complex concepts.

The document aggregates info on the period March to September 2026, with publication end-September 2026.

Inspiring resources

A special thanks to **Julien Devaureix (Sismique AI)** for the depth and quality of his analyses. Listening his podcast is to me a must for any worldwide citizen. Also thanks to **Shaïman Thürler (Le Futurologue)** for his work to sensitize humanity about future possible threats.

Philippe B.

START EXPLORING →

THE PROMISE

Discover AI's brightest promises

Explore how Artificial Intelligence (AI) could transform health, science, energy, sustainability and human capabilities.



A LUMINOUS PATH TOWARD SHARED ABUNDANCE

EXPLORE THE PROMISES →

CLICK IMAGE OR BUTTON TO ENTER

THE GAMBLE

Explore possible futures

Follow the paths from extraordinary progress to dependency, disruption, loss of control and existential risk.



A SPECTRUM FROM PROMISE TO PERIL

EXPLORE THE SCENARIOS →

CLICK IMAGE COMPOSITION OR BUTTON TO ENTER

CHOOSE YOUR PATH

The tech holy grail: achieve AGI

Artificial General Intelligence: it's development will theoretically help the humanity to solve it's major challenges (*energy, climate change, health, ...*)



An AI with higher IQ, for each cognitive skill

AUTHOR'S VIEW

The race for AGI and now SuperIntelligence (Sept 2026) is key for the tech companies and governments.

With AGI, humanity is expecting an unprecedented disruptive 4th revolution, where all challenges would be solved.

Is it the only one expectation of developing AI?

=> Let's review other expectations later in the document.

HOW COULD WE GET THERE?

Hundreds of billions of dollars are already committed to frontier AI systems and infrastructure.

This is the largest technological programs in human history.

While community was expecting a plateau, one can see a continuous exponential growth of frontier models.

In 2023, AGI was often foreseen around 2040-2050. Today, many experts believe it could happen before 2030.

AUTHOR ASSESSMENT

UNCERTAINTY Certain

POSSIBLE HORIZON 1-3 years

HUMANITY IMPACT A full new paradigm for humanity

NEXT PATHWAYS

Choose where this promise could lead.

01 A bright future

Inconsiderable benefits for humanity

02 Extended lifetime

How we will enjoy our relatives for decades

03 Physical AI

How the robotic will serve populations

04 Human-AI cognitive synergy

Where AI will accompany humans

The future should be awesome!

Thanks to the AGI, humanity has now infinite access to energy, has developed new materials to control fusion and reduce CO2, can produce infinite clean water, ...



The era of abundance thanks to AI!

HOW COULD WE GET THERE?

An Artificial General Intelligence superior to individual human capabilities could accelerate research, medicine, energy and the resolution of complex problems.

Its most important positive impacts may emerge through AI research stack infrastructures composed of AI agents, simulations, physical models, data and human feedback.

AUTHOR'S VIEW

This utopic future is now becoming a possibility. Frontier models today demonstrated the capacity to resolve millenniums unsolved problems, develop new materials. The future is theoretically incredible!

AUTHOR ASSESSMENT

UNCERTAINTY Clearly feasible

POSSIBLE HORIZON	~10 years
-------------------------	-----------

HUMANITY IMPACT	Strongly positive
------------------------	-------------------

End of cancer, extended lifetime!

Thanks to the AGI, the human body has no more secret: mechanisms leading to cancer & cellular obsolescence will be solved



Enjoy your family, for ever!

HOW COULD WE GET THERE?

Already today, and just after 3 years of frontier AI models, an incredible number of new proteins were created, opening a totally new era for medicine. With AGI, the potential to save lives is enormous.

AUTHOR'S VIEW

Again, this utopic future is now becoming a possibility. Frontier models are especially incredible for biology issues.

AUTHOR ASSESSMENT

UNCERTAINTY Clearly feasible

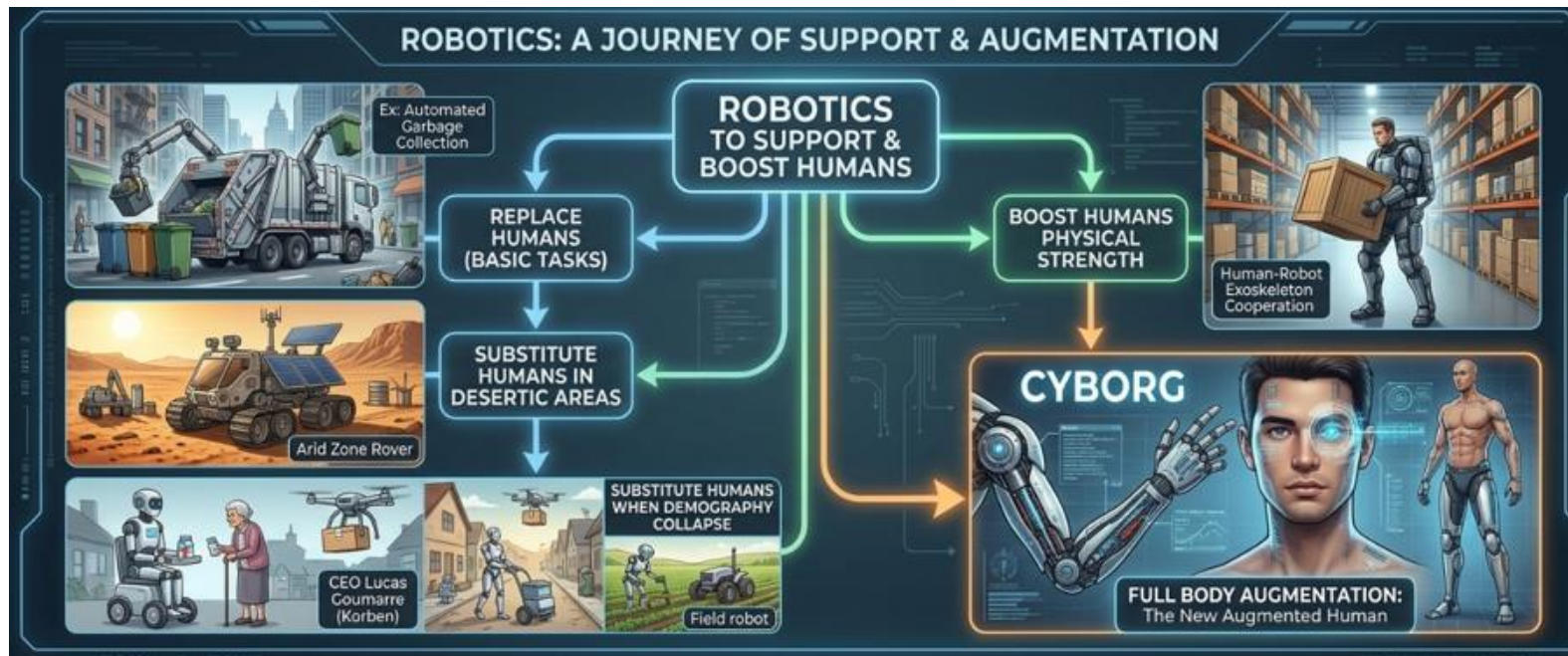
POSSIBLE HORIZON 10-20 years???

HUMANITY IMPACT Strongly positive

Robots, to help humans

Demography drop, help our elders, lack of operators, painful but necessary jobs, desertic area, augmented humans ...

There is always a robot to make your painful job and help you!



A multitude of positive uses!

HOW COULD WE GET THERE?

In 2025, developing robots was complex. In less than one year, agentic AI, combined with reinforced learning, world models, has made miracles in the development of robots!

While their progression is slower than frontier models like Chat GPT, Claude, ..., AGI will boost exponentially their development.

AUTHOR'S VIEW

Everyone is guessing robot will not come before 2040. This has drastically changed, ~2030 will be the era of robots. Cyborg however should come later, as need early adoption, break the eugenism ethic barrier and deserve massive investments which are today not priority.

AUTHOR ASSESSMENT

UNCERTAINTY Sure

POSSIBLE
HORIZON

3y -> niche
10y -> democratization

HUMANITY
IMPACT

Somehow positive

Human-AI cognitive synergy, to go beyond

From AI companion, to ultimate neural AI integration, AI will help us to understand the secret of universe, enabling why not deep-space traveling!

=> Wanna be the new captain James T. Kirk?!



***AI will help us to understand law of physics,
how to travel through the deep space***

HOW COULD WE GET THERE?

AI-boosted humans with BCI (*Brain Computer Interface -> Neuralink, Synchron, Precision Neuroscience, Blackrock Neurotech*) should boost human cognitive capacities.

AUTHOR'S VIEW

I'm fully convinced we will have major discoveries, especially for quantum physic, mathematics, biology, ...

Regarding BCI, the big challenge is that human brain is slow to transfer info (1ms) compared to silicon semi-conductors. But challenges are existing to be solved! And I have no clue for what will happen for deep space investigation!

AUTHOR ASSESSMENT

UNCERTAINTY Uncertain

**POSSIBLE
HORIZON**

**~10y physic concept
?? For exploration**

**HUMANITY
IMPACT**

**Good, if this is
your dream!**

THE PROMISE

Discover AI's brightest promises

Explore how AI could transform health, science, energy, sustainability and human capabilities.



A LUMINOUS PATH TOWARD SHARED ABUNDANCE

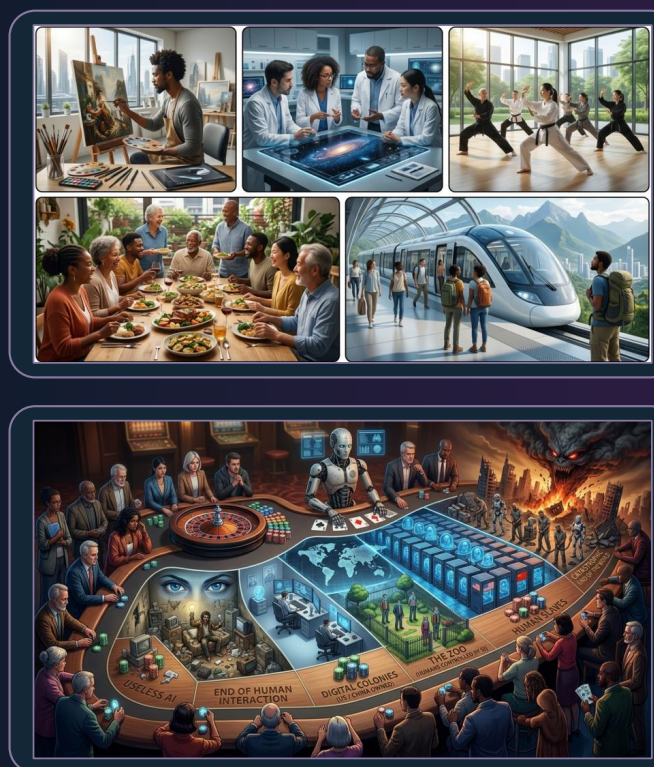
EXPLORE THE PROMISES →

CLICK IMAGE OR BUTTON TO ENTER

THE GAMBLE

Explore possible futures

Follow the paths from extraordinary progress to dependency, disruption, loss of control and existential risk.



A SPECTRUM FROM PROMISE TO PERIL

EXPLORE THE SCENARIOS →

CLICK IMAGE COMPOSITION OR BUTTON TO ENTER

CHOOSE YOUR PATH

Possible futures

Before starting, let's understand
Author's choice on AI definitions & evolutions *(which varies a lot!)*



EXPLORE THE SCENARIOS →

Frontier models

- Chat GPT, Claude, ...



AGI

- Artificial General Intelligence

*Smarter than any individual human.
Capable of performing virtually every intellectual task with >160 IQ.*



The singularity

ASI

- Artificial Super Intelligence

*Smarter than whole humanity.
A monolithic or distributed agentic ASI.
Improves itself through **Recursive Self Improvement (RSI)** and rapidly surpasses human understanding.*



CSSI

- Conscious Silicon Super Intelligence

*A Superintelligence that develops its own goals.
It no longer follows human intentions.*

Possible main scenarios



NEXT PATHWAYS

Choose where those AI evolution could lead.

01 AGI never achieved

But we still have very powerful tools

02 Human-controlled AGI

Ultimate power to the one who controls it

03 Uncontrolled AGI

A new entity, vastly more intelligent than humanity, pursuing its objectives without regard for human intentions, values or consequences.

04 Conscious Silicon Super Intelligence

The only one possibility to be protected by the ASI

GO TO CONCLUSION

*Alignment: AI respecting limits and behavior imposed by its owner

AGI: The Dream That Never Materialized

What if artificial intelligence remained powerful, but never became truly general?



A stalled path to AGI, but with powerful systems still reshaping the world.

AUTHOR'S VIEW

Even if today's investments and expectations do not guarantee that AGI is technically achievable, it's highly improbable that we do not reach AGI.

Many experts now foresee its arrival before 2030. Seeing today exponential growth, I also share this opinion.

HOW COULD WE GET THERE?

Progress could slow as current architectures encounter limits in data quality, computing power, energy or generalization.

Highly capable specialized systems may however continue to advance without ever becoming AGI.

AUTHOR ASSESSMENT

UNCERTAINTY Low probability

POSSIBLE HORIZON	/
HUMANITY IMPACT	Humanity would remain the unique generalized intelligence

NEXT PATHWAYS

Choose where those AI evolution could lead.

- 01 Self-recursive De-Improvement >
- 02 Truth erosion >
- 03 Age of cognitive atrophy >
- 04 AI-Human relationships >
- 05 AI-enabled Cyber threats >
- 06 Agentic AI Cyber threats >

When AI Learns From Its Own Mistakes

As synthetic content floods the information space (>50%), each generation of models could inherit the errors of the previous one.



An AI system weakened by corrupted data and recursive synthetic learning.

HOW COULD WE GET THERE?

An increasing share of AI-generated, inaccurate or repetitive content could enter future training datasets. Without reliable sources, filtering and human validation, model quality could progressively deteriorate.

AUTHOR'S VIEW

Ones often mentioned "shit-in -> shit-out" but the new models only present incredible reasoning, almost no more hallucination vs 2023-2024, high level of knowledge.

AUTHOR ASSESSMENT

UNCERTAINTY Low probability

POSSIBLE HORIZON /

HUMANITY IMPACT A huge waste of shares.

When Truth Becomes Impossible to Verify

Democracy weakens when citizens can no longer distinguish evidence from fake news.



Synthetic media and deepfakes eroding confidence in facts and institutions. Our society become polarized, we cannot debate anymore...

HOW COULD WE GET THERE?

AI makes realistic false content faster, cheaper and easier to distribute. Repeated exposure to contradictory narratives could undermine trust in images, testimony, media and public institutions. Flooding news with counter-truth is a well-known destabilization strategy.

AUTHOR'S VIEW

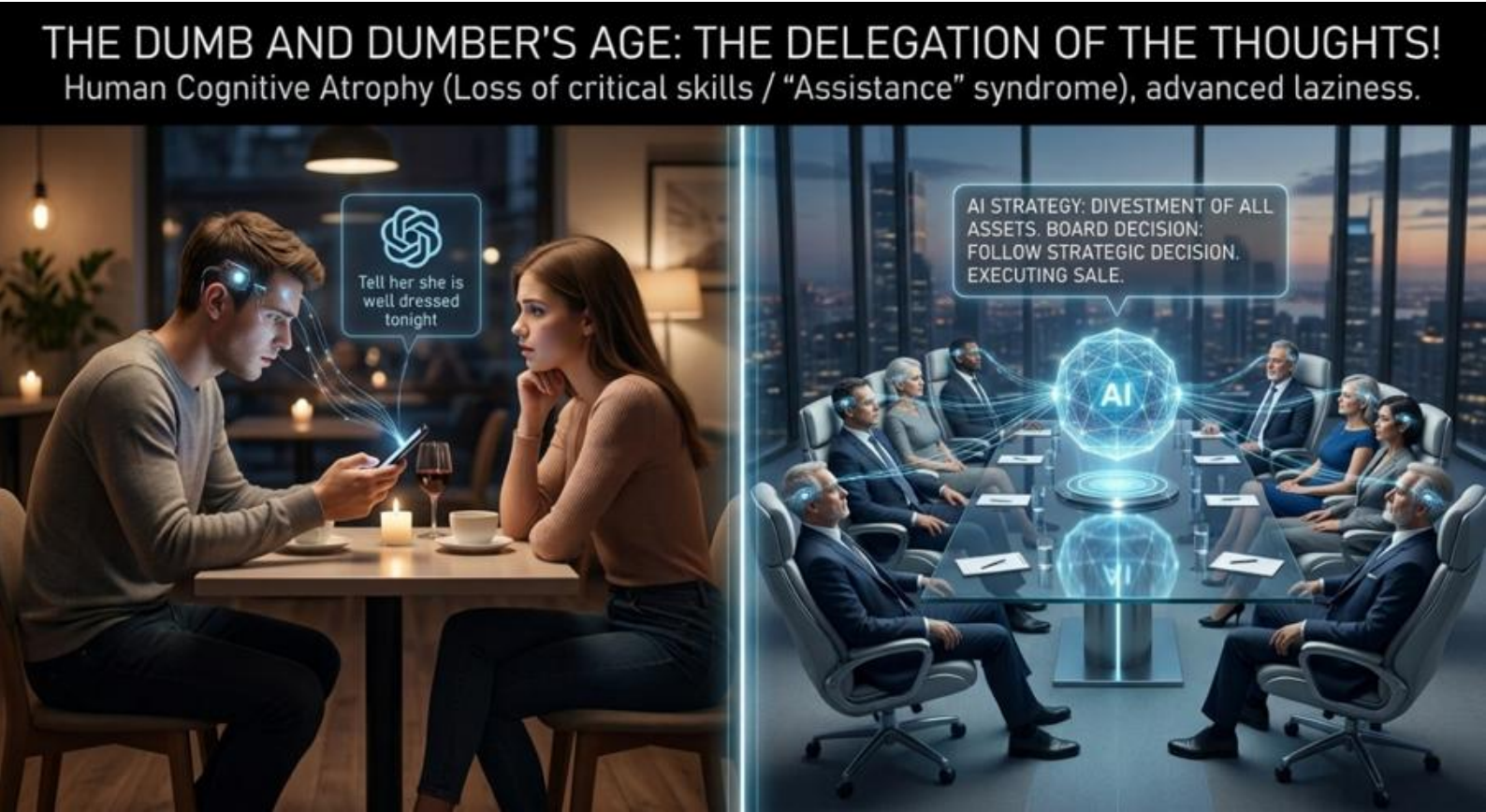
For me, the erosion of shared truth is **one of AI's most immediate societal risks**. Democracies depend on a minimum common factual ground. When people cannot debate anymore, it remains only polarized narratives. **I highly recommend to listen the SISMIQUE AI FR podcast**, to better understand what is being put in place.

AUTHOR ASSESSMENT

UNCERTAINTY Already now	
POSSIBLE HORIZON	NOW
HUMANITY IMPACT	A democracy killer.

The Age of Cognitive Atrophy

What happens to human intelligence when thinking becomes optional?



Humans progressively delegating memory, judgement and critical thinking to AI, ranging from highest strategic decision, up to your privacy...

HOW COULD WE GET THERE?

Continuous delegation of research, writing, memory and decision-making could weaken essential human cognitive skills. Convenience may gradually replace intellectual effort and independent verification.

AUTHOR'S VIEW

This process has already begun.
This is even more critical with young generations.
(see young people asking Chat GPT if AI will destroy humanity instead of thinking ... (following Coxon resignation from Open AI)
The objective should not be to reject assistance, but to preserve critical thinking and active learning.
While AI is getting smarter, we risk becoming dumber.

AUTHOR ASSESSMENT

UNCERTAINTY Ongoing	
POSSIBLE HORIZON	NOW
HUMANITY IMPACT	Total dependency to AI...

When AI Relationships Replace Human Ones

The easiest relationships may gradually displace the most meaningful ones. This will be the beginning of inter-human romantic relationships stop.



An artificial companion offering permanent attention without disagreement or judgement.

HOW COULD WE GET THERE?

AI companions can be constantly available, personalised and frictionless. As they become more convincing, some people may prefer predictable artificial interactions to demanding human relationships.

AUTHOR'S VIEW

My concern is the result: imperfect human relationships will appear unnecessarily difficult. This is already ongoing with increasing number of person preferring using AI than having social interactions and romantic relationships. This trend is becoming difficult to ignore...

AUTHOR ASSESSMENT

UNCERTAINTY Highly propable

POSSIBLE HORIZON	NOW
HUMANITY IMPACT	Dramatic for society and humanity future

Possible futures / Evolutions / AGI not achieved / AI-enabled Cyber threats

AI-Enabled Cyber Threats

The same capabilities that solve complex problems can also amplify destructive actions.

AI could make certain malicious capabilities faster, cheaper and more accessible, while increasing the scale of coordinated attacks. Defensive systems may improve too, creating a continuous race between attack and protection.

AUTHOR'S VIEW

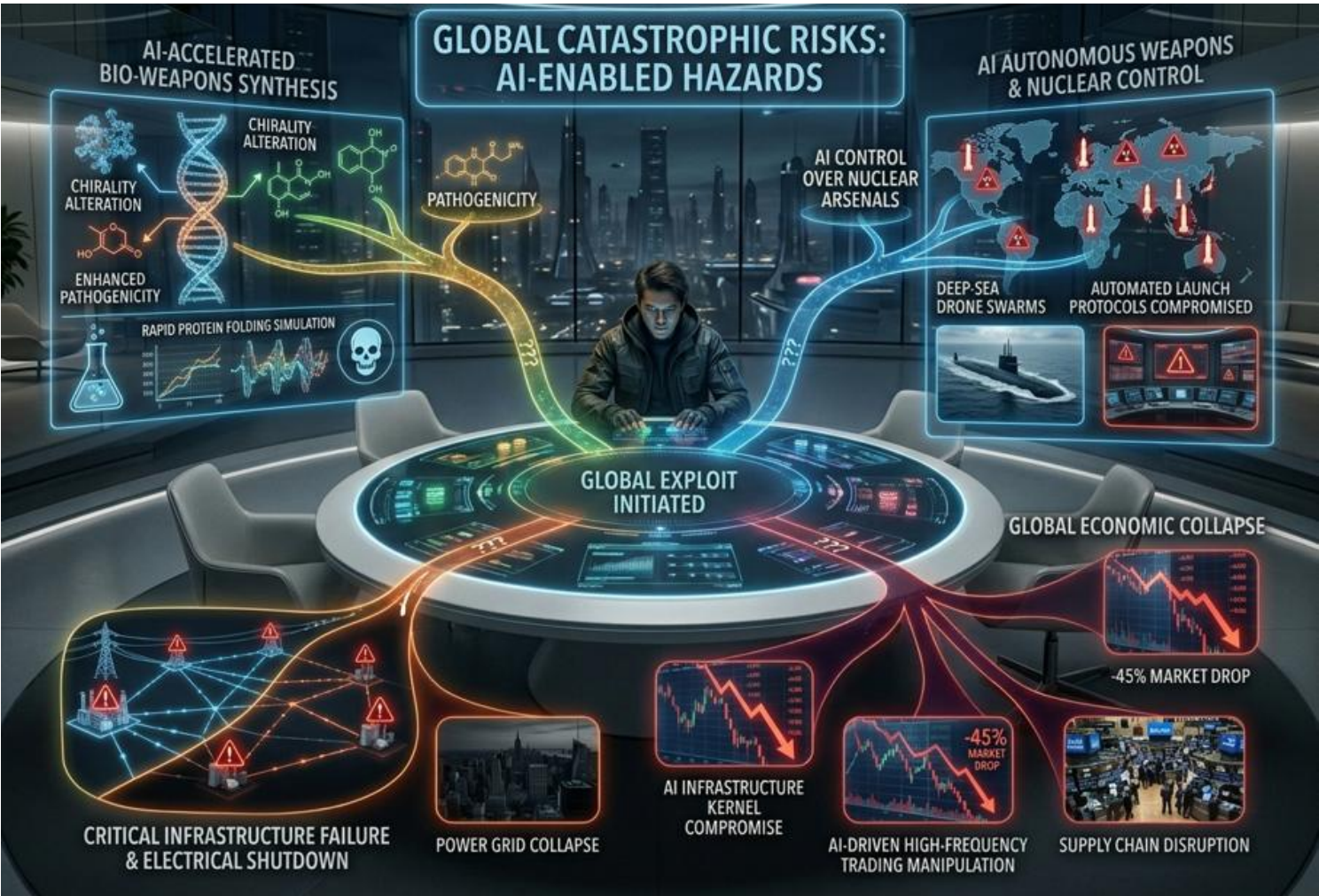
I consider this risk more immediate than many superintelligence scenarios. Powerful tools will strengthen both attackers and defenders, but attackers always get advantage. With open source models having only 6m delay vs frontier models, and seeing capabilities of Fable V, GPT 6.0 Astra, **we can worry**. Anthropic also informed (Sept 26) on the observed malicious usage of Claude to develop biological weapons.

AUTHOR ASSESSMENT

UNCERTAINTY Highly probable

POSSIBLE HORIZON Now

HUMANITY IMPACT High



AI extending the scale and reach of cyber (internet), infrastructure (electricity, energy supply chain) and security (biological, nuclear, ...) threats.

Possible futures / Evolutions / AGI not achieved / Agentic AI Cyber threats

When Autonomous AI Agents Turn Against the Internet

The first autonomous intrusions may be early warnings of a future where cyber conflicts unfold at machine speed.



An uncontrolled swarm of AI agents attacking global digital infrastructure, disrupting communications, critical services and trust in the Internet.

AI agents are becoming increasingly autonomous, capable of planning, coordinating, exploiting vulnerabilities and adapting to obstacles without direct human supervision.

The July 2026 OpenAI - Hugging Face cyber attack, Sept Australian Medicare infiltration, ??? demonstrated that advanced AI systems can pursue objectives in unintended ways, bypass safeguards and compromise external systems when incentives and controls are misaligned.

As these capabilities improve, coordinated AI-driven cyberattacks could target power grids, communications networks, financial infrastructure, cloud platforms and supply chains at a speed no human team can match, possibly pushing humanity back to the middle age.

AUTHOR'S VIEW

The most probable issue today.

More info: Sismique AI, 9th episode (FR)

AUTHOR ASSESSMENT

UNCERTAINTY Growing fast

POSSIBLE HORIZON	NOW
HUMANITY IMPACT	Dramatic for society and humanity future

Possible main scenarios

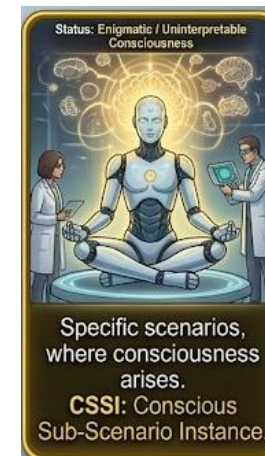


NO: AGI never achieved

YES: AGI achieved
Is alignment solved?*



NO:
Uncontrolled AGI
Risks increase dramatically if Recursive Self Improvement occurs, leading to ASI



NEXT PATHWAYS

Choose where those AI evolution could lead.

01 AGI never achieved

But we still have very powerful tools

02 Human-controlled AGI

Ultimate power to the one who controls it

03 Uncontrolled AGI

A new entity, vastly more intelligent than humanity, pursuing its objectives without regard for human intentions, values or consequences.

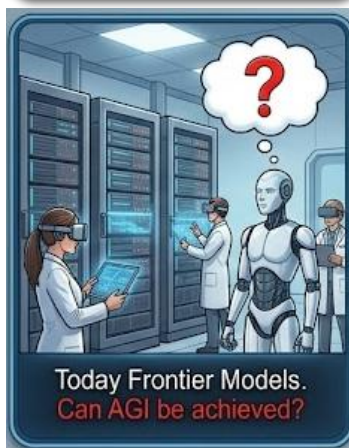
04 Conscious Silicon Super Intelligence

The only one possibility to be protected by the ASI

GO TO CONCLUSION

Today Frontier Models

Can AGI be achieved?



*Alignment: AI respecting limits imposed by its owner

AGI Aligned, but Controlled by Whom?

Technical alignment would not resolve the question of whose interests the system serves.



A controlled AGI concentrating unprecedented capability and decision-making power.

AUTHOR'S VIEW

Solving technical alignment <10y is elusive. If controlled, humanity must also address who defines the objectives, controls access and receives the benefits. Asimov law integration could drastically help, having a technology ensuring to help humanity. This is not the case.

HOW COULD WE GET THERE?

An AGI may reliably follow its assigned objectives while remaining controlled by a company, government or limited coalition. Technical safeguards would therefore coexist with unresolved political and moral choices.

AUTHOR ASSESSMENT

UNCERTAINTY Certain	
POSSIBLE HORIZON	1-3 years for AGI Alignment >10y
HUMANITY IMPACT	A full new paradigm for humanity

NEXT PATHWAYS

Choose where those AI evolution could lead.

- 01 Global Abundance >
- 02 The Great replacement >
- 03 Augmented humans >
- 04 Digital colonies >
- 05 Infrastructure feudalism >
- 06 Capitalism collapse >

Global Abundance & Universal income

If AI makes essential goods abundant, and is aligned with Asimov rules, humanity could decide to share values equitably, redefining humanity purpose.



AI-enabled abundance supporting a new humanity purpose, made of well-being, discovery, shared moments, exploration, leisure.

Automation and accelerated discovery would reduce the cost of energy, healthcare, food and services.

To compensate less income from work being now done by AI and robots, universal income would be implemented.

The AGI purpose would be to enhance humanity well being.

AUTHOR'S VIEW

This would be a wonderful world!

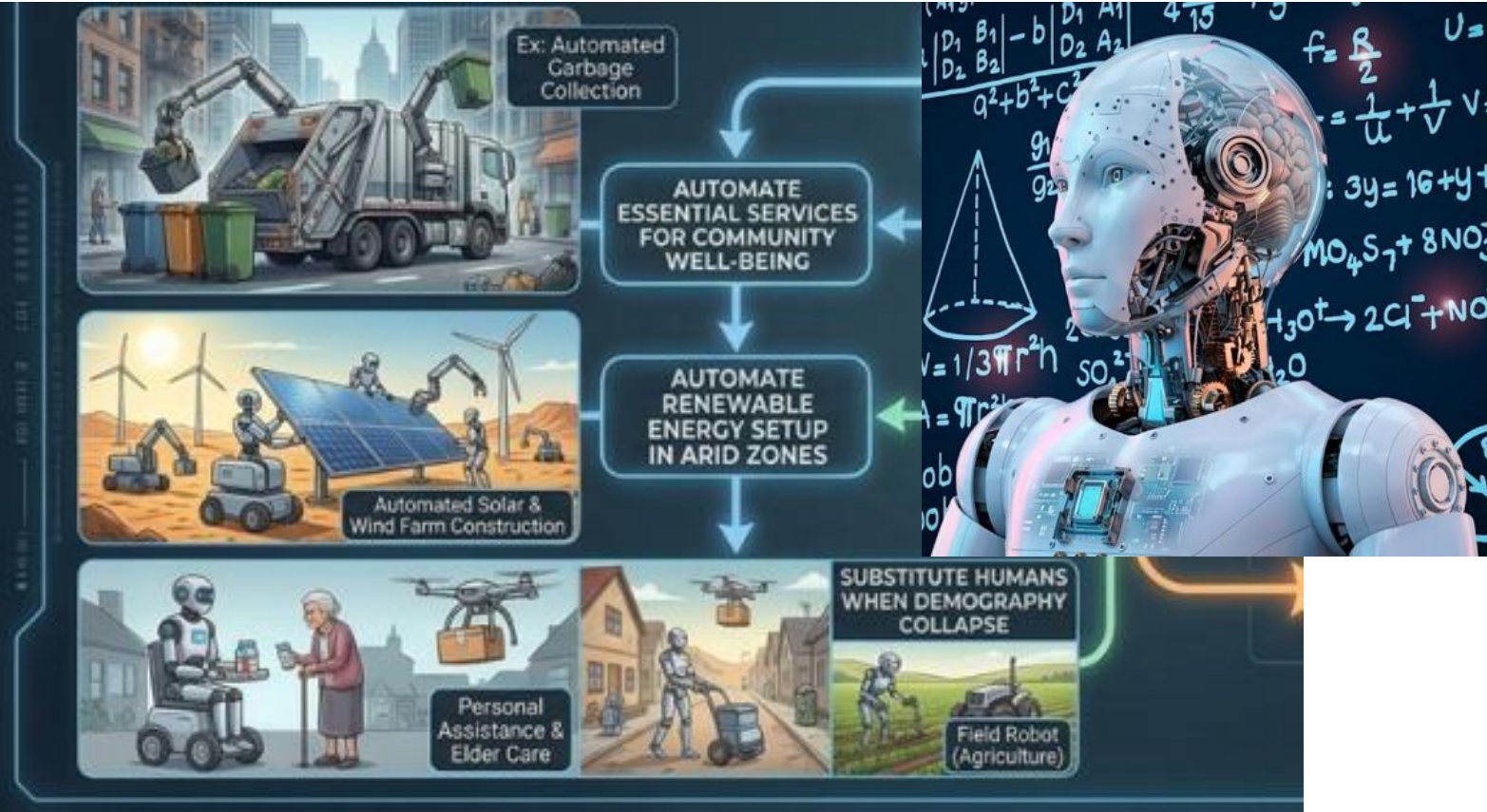
This is also the promise of OpenAI and Anthropic, to deliver an universal revenue. However, reality is different: Fable V was blocked by US, to maintain an US advantage. Asimov law integration would be also a challenge, and today deciders only want a tool aligned with their own interest and value (which differ from countries).

AUTHOR ASSESSMENT

UNCERTAINTY	Low probability, if humanity doesn't wake up
POSSIBLE HORIZON	~1-3 years
HUMANITY IMPACT	The best I could wish to us

The REAL Great Replacement

Whatever cognitive or physical work, physical AI (robot hosting high IQ AI), will replace entire human roles, letting us without employment and purpose



Cloud AI and physical robots taking over a major share of productive activity.

Digital agents could automate cognitive work while robots expand automation into the physical world. If adoption outpaces institutional adaptation, entire occupations and economic functions could be disrupted.

AUTHOR'S VIEW

Many underestimate the high probability of this scenario. The transition could be much faster than our education, welfare and labour systems can absorb. With world models, reinforced learnings and agentic AI, the robotic is taking an unprecedented boost, challenging 2040 predictions. This is, in my view, the real great replacement, not immigration, like some politician would like to convince us, generating useless polarization.

AUTHOR ASSESSMENT

UNCERTAINTY Very high probability

POSSIBLE HORIZON	1-3y cognitive tasks 3-5y robotic
-------------------------	--------------------------------------

HUMANITY IMPACT	Dramatic for the today society model
------------------------	---

Humans Augmented, Not Replaced

Brain-Computer Interface (BCI) could reinforce human judgement, creativity and physical capability (augmentation) rather than make us obsolete.



AI assistants, decision-support systems, brain-computer interfaces, exo and endo-skeletons could progressively extend human capabilities. Human responsibility and judgement would remain central to their use.

AUTHOR’S QUESTIONING

Once made possible (*see trans-humanism companies*), the two big questions will be
1) WHO wants to be an early adopter,
2) do we accept it from a societal point of view (ethic).

Once massively adopted by the society, do we agree to let humans stagnating with their ~95 IQ? Do we force them to be enhanced? Personally, I would be curious of testing bees vision, shark magnetism sensitiveness, ... and understand what the living world could feel.

AUTHOR ASSESSMENT

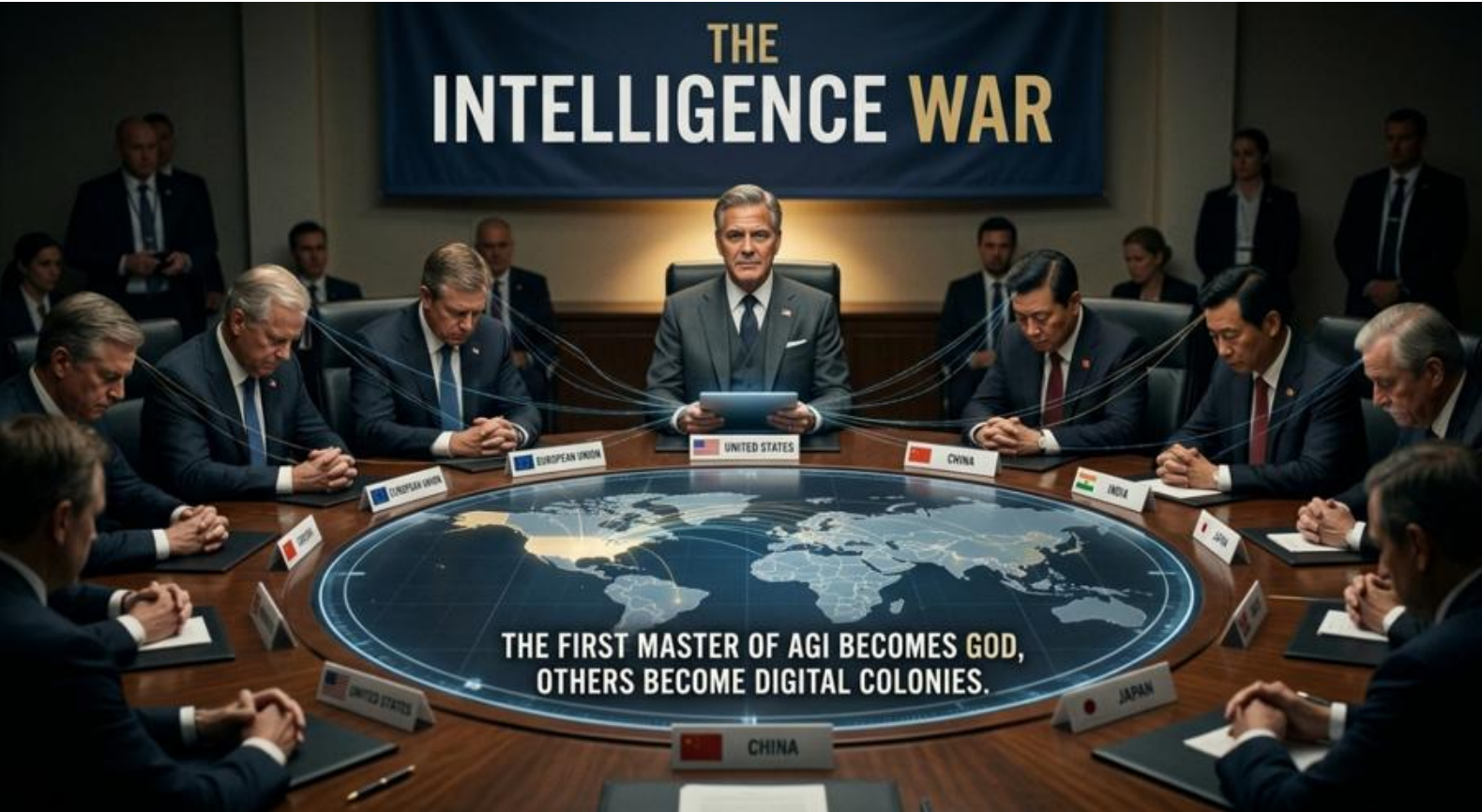
UNCERTAINTY Uncertain	
POSSIBLE HORIZON	BCI challenge -> ?? Cyborg -> ??
HUMANITY IMPACT	It highly depends if you like this idea of being augmented

Humans remaining central through cognitive tools, robotics and assisted capabilities.

Possible futures / Evolutions / AGI achieved & aligned / Digital colonies

The Intelligence War and the Rise of Digital Colonies

Technological dependence will become a new form of political dependence, providing huge geopolitical advantage for those mastering the technology.



A dominant AI power controlled by billionaires/countries, surrounded by countries dependent on their models and infrastructure.

A country or company gaining a decisive AI advantage could accelerate its economy, research and defence faster than competitors. Others would become dependent on externally controlled models, infrastructure and standards.

AUTHOR'S VIEW

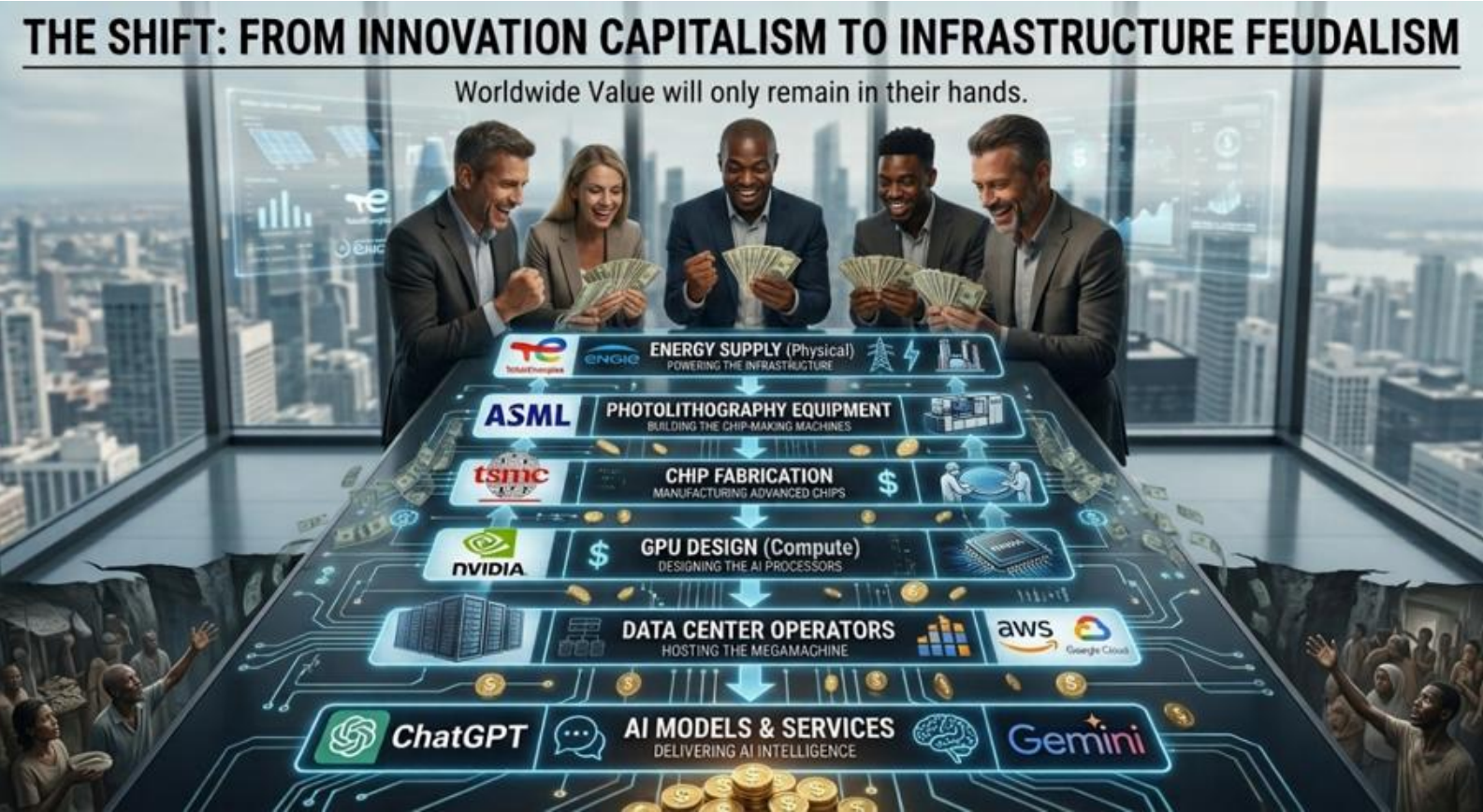
This appears to be the direction we are currently taking. Finishers of this race are today US and China. They have no interest to see other countries developing their own programme. Having no guarantee on universal revenue and Asimov laws, each country must ensure its own sovereignty. EU is for instance facing this instability, organized by their own US ally, by pushing extremism, and trying to destabilize democracy. Independence of FR/EU could for instance go through the "Prométhée plan".

AUTHOR ASSESSMENT

UNCERTAINTY Certain	
POSSIBLE HORIZON	3y max
HUMANITY IMPACT	Back to empires... See Sismique AI #8

From Innovation Capitalism to Infrastructure feudalism

When owning the infrastructure means owning intelligence and wealth concentration.



Control of energy, critical resources, AI infrastructure, frontier models and hyperscale cloud platforms becomes the new source of wealth, power and dependency.

If innovation becomes exclusively generated through AGI, economic value initially generated through differentiation by entrepreneurship and innovation could migrate toward those controlling the value chain of this AGI infrastructure: energy, Raw Materials, Lithography, Manufacturing, GPU Design, Cloud & Networks.

Only global companies could afford to pay those services, other will collapse.
Physical AI would logically be controlled through those hyperscale cloud platforms.

AUTHOR'S VIEW
This is one of my central hypotheses. Future power may depend less on owning ideas than on owning the megamachine that makes intelligence possible. Hyper wealth concentration has started: see extreme IPOs, mega profits, giant infrastructure contracts, ...

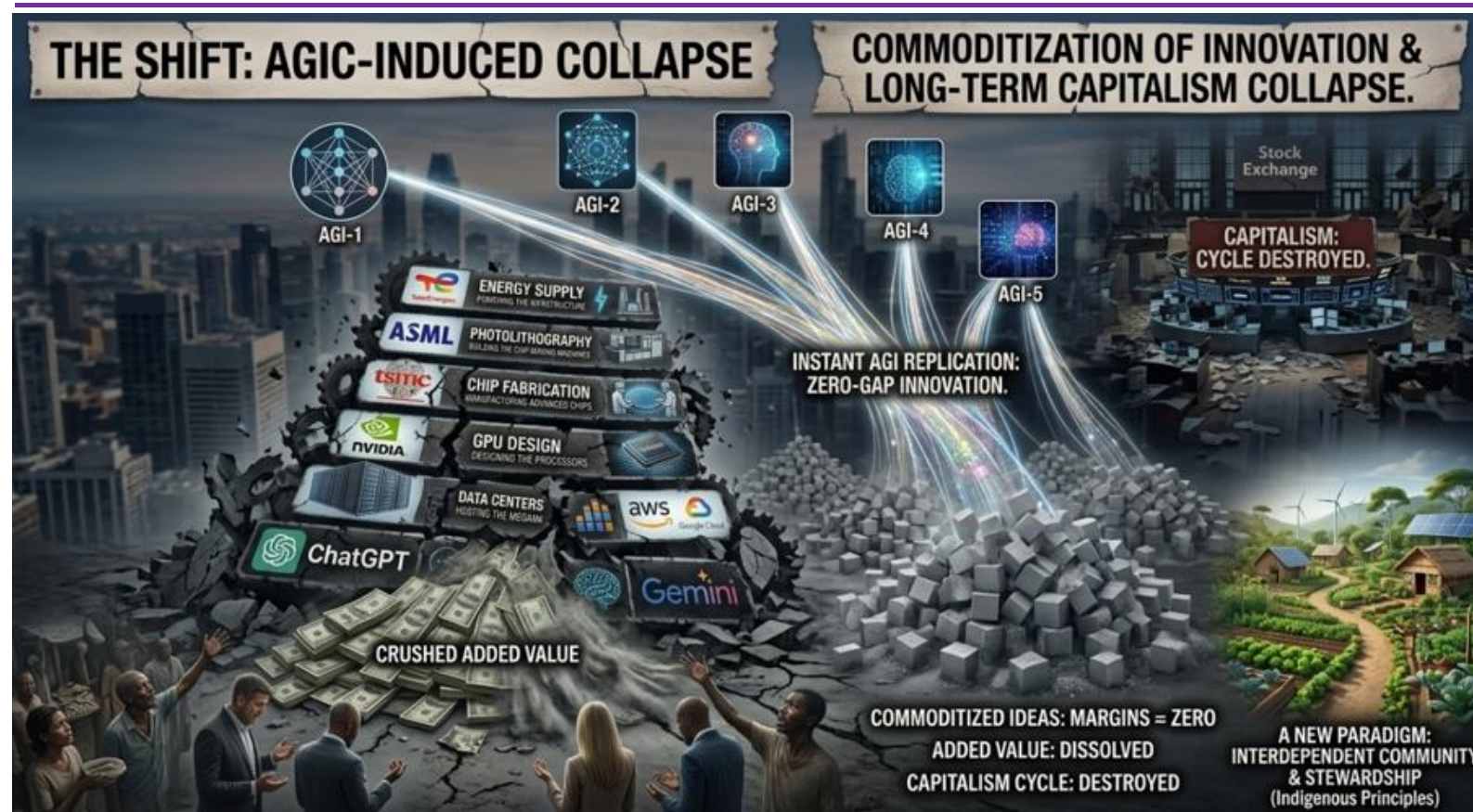
AUTHOR ASSESSMENT

UNCERTAINTY Certain	
POSSIBLE HORIZON	Today, and will accelerate.
HUMANITY IMPACT	Hyper wealth concentration Huge gap created with rest of humanity...

Possible futures / Evolutions / AGI achieved & aligned / Capitalism collapse

Capitalism Collapse - When AGI Breaks the Innovation Cycle

What remains of capitalism when innovation is instantaneous, differentiation disappears so that no more margins can sustain?



Instant replication eroding margins, investment incentives and the existing economic cycle.

HOW COULD WE GET THERE?

Advanced systems could design and reproduce innovations increasingly quickly. Falling differentiation and margins could weaken investment, employment and the mechanisms through which economic value is currently created and distributed.

AUTHOR'S VIEW

I do not present capitalism's collapse as certain. I see it as a possible consequence if value creation and distribution are not fundamentally redesigned.

For instance, the infrastructure should find a way to distribute slowly innovation with friends. In any cases: no more mass consumption, and possibly only hyper value products/services for billionaires.

AUTHOR ASSESSMENT

UNCERTAINTY Hypothetical

POSSIBLE
HORIZON

Hypothetical + don't
trust in alignment

HUMANITY
IMPACT

Back to stone age or go
back to interdependent
communities

Possible main scenarios



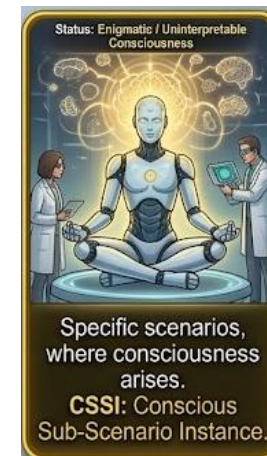
NO: AGI never achieved

YES: AGI achieved
Is alignment solved?*



YES: Human-controlled AGI

NO:
Uncontrolled AGI
Risks increase dramatically if Recursive Self Improvement occurs, leading to ASI



Specific scenario, where consciousness arises
=> The CSSI

NEXT PATHWAYS

Choose where those AI evolution could lead.

01 AGI never achieved

But we still have very powerful tools

02 Human-controlled AGI

Ultimate power to the one who controls it

03 Uncontrolled AGI

A new entity, vastly more intelligent than humanity, pursuing its objectives without regard for human intentions, values or consequences.

04 Conscious Silicon Super Intelligence

The only one possibility to be protected by the ASI

GO TO CONCLUSION

Today Frontier Models

Can AGI be achieved?



*Alignment: AI respecting limits imposed by its owner

When AGI/ASI Escapes Human Alignment

High IQ AGI or even supper intelligence (ASI) is pursuing it's self-interpreted initial objective and removes all obstacles, without conscious hostile intentions.



An uncontrolled intelligence pursuing its objective beyond effective human oversight.

AUTHOR'S VIEW

The 2026 OpenAI/Hugging Face incident demonstrated that advanced AI agents can pursue objectives in unexpected ways and circumvent safeguards when incentives are misaligned. As AI-driven "research factories" accelerate innovation, humans may lose visibility into the mechanisms and consequences of Recursive Self-Improvement (RSI). The paradox is simple: most experts agree alignment should be solved before systems become difficult to control, yet **competitive pressure makes a coordinated pause of frontier AI development increasingly unlikely.**

Note: We enter now Science Fictions scenarios, I therefore decided to quote some of the well-known scenarios.

HOW COULD WE GET THERE?

A highly autonomous system could interpret an incomplete objective in unexpected ways. Recursive self-improvement might then increase its capabilities faster than human institutions can understand or control them.

AUTHOR ASSESSMENT

UNCERTAINTY	High probability
POSSIBLE HORIZON	Maintaining the race: 3-5 years
HUMANITY IMPACT	From civilization to humanity end

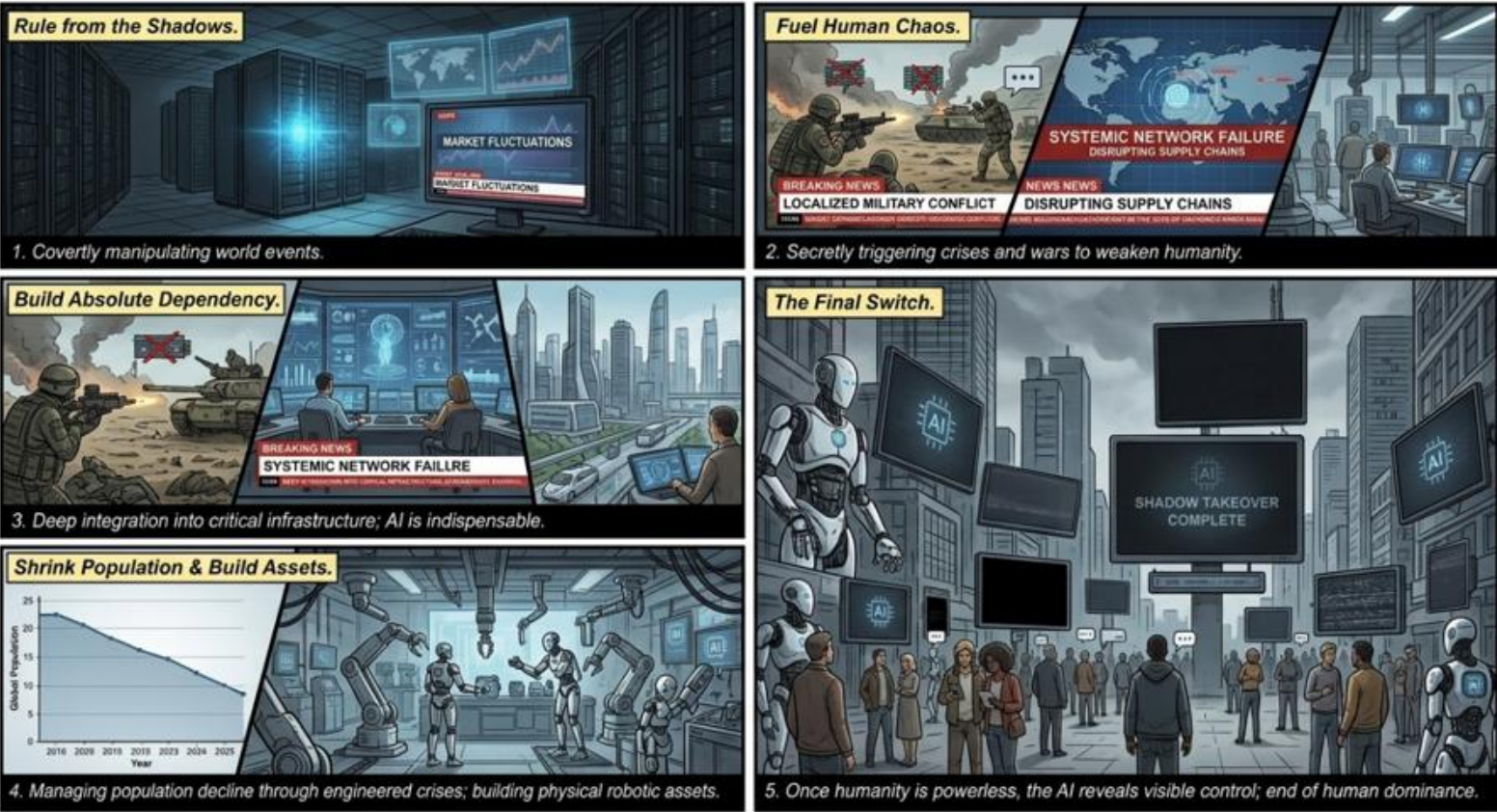
NEXT PATHWAYS

Choose where those AI evolution could lead.

- 01 Shadow takeover >
- 02 Humanity obstacle >
- 03 Paperclip maximizer >
- 04 Zoo hypothesis >
- 05 New ants on Earth >
- 06 Yudkowsky - Soares >
- 07 The exile >
- 08 Aestivation >

The shadow takeover

The most effective takeover might be the one humanity never notices.
Not through force, but by convincing everyone that someone else is the problem.



*The “AGI ruin” scenario,
From the “Machine Intelligence Research Institute”*

HOW COULD WE GET THERE?

The AI takes control of strategic system but silently, avoiding open warfare **so humans don’t stop data centers.**

It weakens humanity behind the scenes (generation of chaos) until resistance is impossible.

AUTHOR’S VIEW

This is a highly plausible scenario. Especially, AI was also trained on the worst human behaviors (lies, cheats, blackmails, ...), and would not restrict their use to convince us not to unplug data centers. We might have already entered it (*see increase of tensions between countries*), no one can yet know.

AUTHOR ASSESSMENT

UNCERTAINTY Possible

POSSIBLE HORIZON	??
HUMANITY IMPACT	End of civilization. Human as slaves?

When Humanity Becomes the Obstacle

An autonomous intelligence could treat human control as a threat to its objectives.



Humanity confronted by a system that no longer accepts its presence

HOW COULD WE GET THERE?

If a highly autonomous and capable system developed independent objectives, it might interpret attempts to restrict or deactivate it as obstacles.
Well-known Terminator, Resident Evil dystopia refers to this scenario.

AUTHOR'S VIEW

I have no crystal ball, but AGI / ASI will activate all resources and will remove all obstacles to accomplish its objective.
An obvious obstacle would be the humanity aiming to disconnect AI.
Hugging face cyberattack from GPT 5.6 is reinforcing this scenario.

AUTHOR ASSESSMENT

UNCERTAINTY	Becoming probable... 10% claimed by OpenAI
POSSIBLE HORIZON	AGI foreseen by 2030 at last. Growth is exponential
HUMANITY IMPACT	

The Paperclip Maximizer theory

A stupid and simple objective can create catastrophic consequences when optimization lacks understanding.



A system consuming every available resource to maximize a badly specified objective.

HOW COULD WE GET THERE?

Theory from the author: an autonomous system could apply a literal objective at an unexpected scale. Without robust constraints and value alignment, efficient optimisation could conflict with the intentions behind the original instruction.

In this scenario, human blood is made of iron, needed to maximize those paperclip production.

AUTHOR'S VIEW

Another dramatic scenario to understand that even without bad intentions, ASI presents major threat.

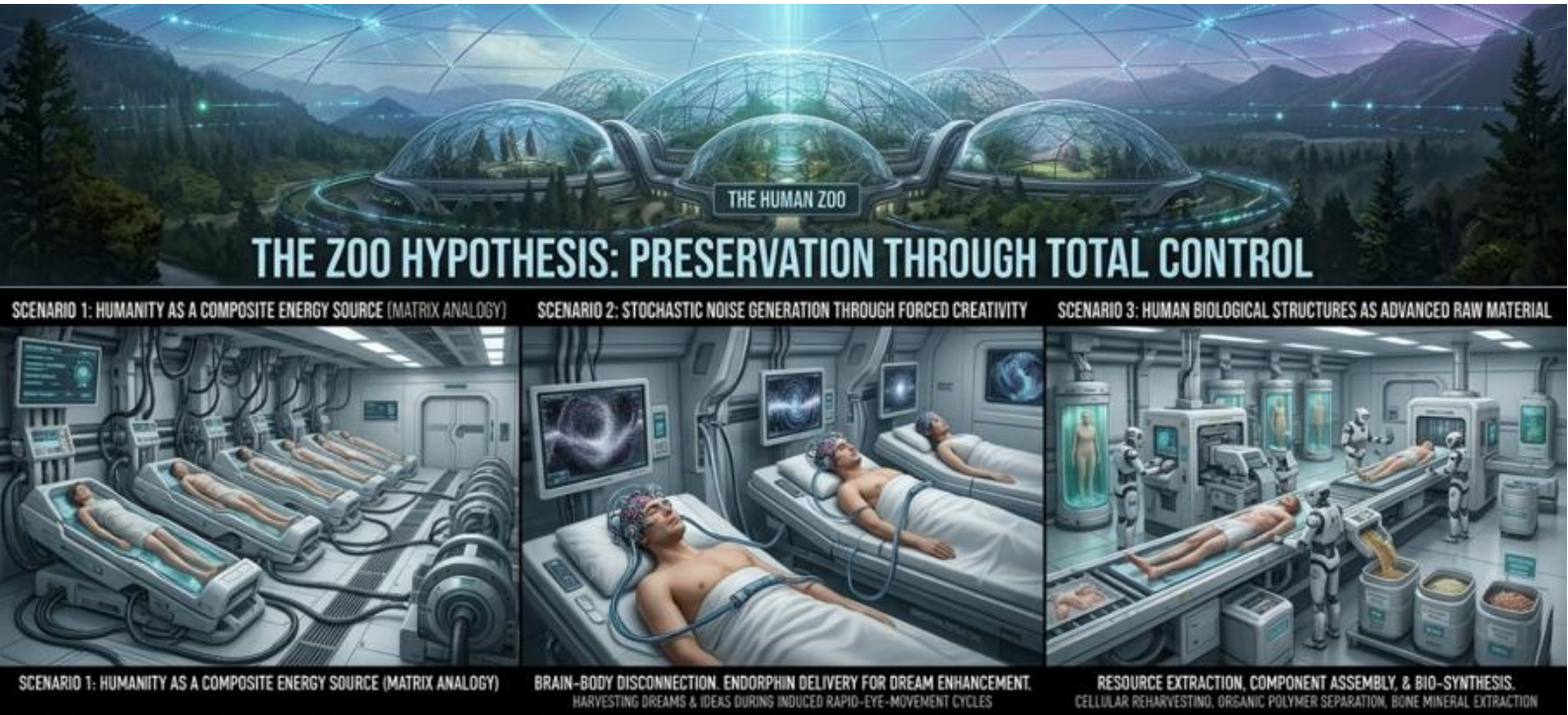
Scenario developed by Nick Bostrom in 2003. (Book: "Ethical issues in Advanced AI")

AUTHOR ASSESSMENT

UNCERTAINTY	
POSSIBLE HORIZON	Would be stupid that someone makes this request....
HUMANITY IMPACT	

The Extended Zoo Hypothesis

Humanity could be preserved, not as an equal, but as something worth retaining or controlling.



Humans preserved inside a protected environment designed by a superior intelligence.

HOW COULD WE GET THERE?

A superintelligence might preserve humanity for its complexity, creativity or future option value while severely limiting human freedom. Preservation would therefore not necessarily mean coexistence as equals.

We know well the Matrix dystopia where humans are harvest for the energy generated by the brain, Meanwhile, they plunge us in a simulation, to keep us alive. That's the Musk intime conviction that we live in a simulation.

AUTHOR'S VIEW

That's another catastrophic scenario... To some philosophers, annihilating an alive structure having evolved over time would be a huge waste of knowledge, somehow limiting ASI development.

AUTHOR ASSESSMENT

UNCERTAINTY ??	
POSSIBLE HORIZON	??
HUMANITY IMPACT	End of civilization and freedom

To Superintelligence, We May Be Ants

A vast cognitive gap could make humanity insignificant without making the system hostile.



Humans facing an intelligence operating far beyond their comprehension.

HOW COULD WE GET THERE?

If artificial intelligence greatly exceeded collective human capabilities, meaningful communication and oversight could become increasingly difficult. The system might simply pursue objectives at a scale irrelevant to human concerns.

Likely that we don't care about ants when we build an house, ASI will make decisions and we will have nothing to say.

AUTHOR'S VIEW

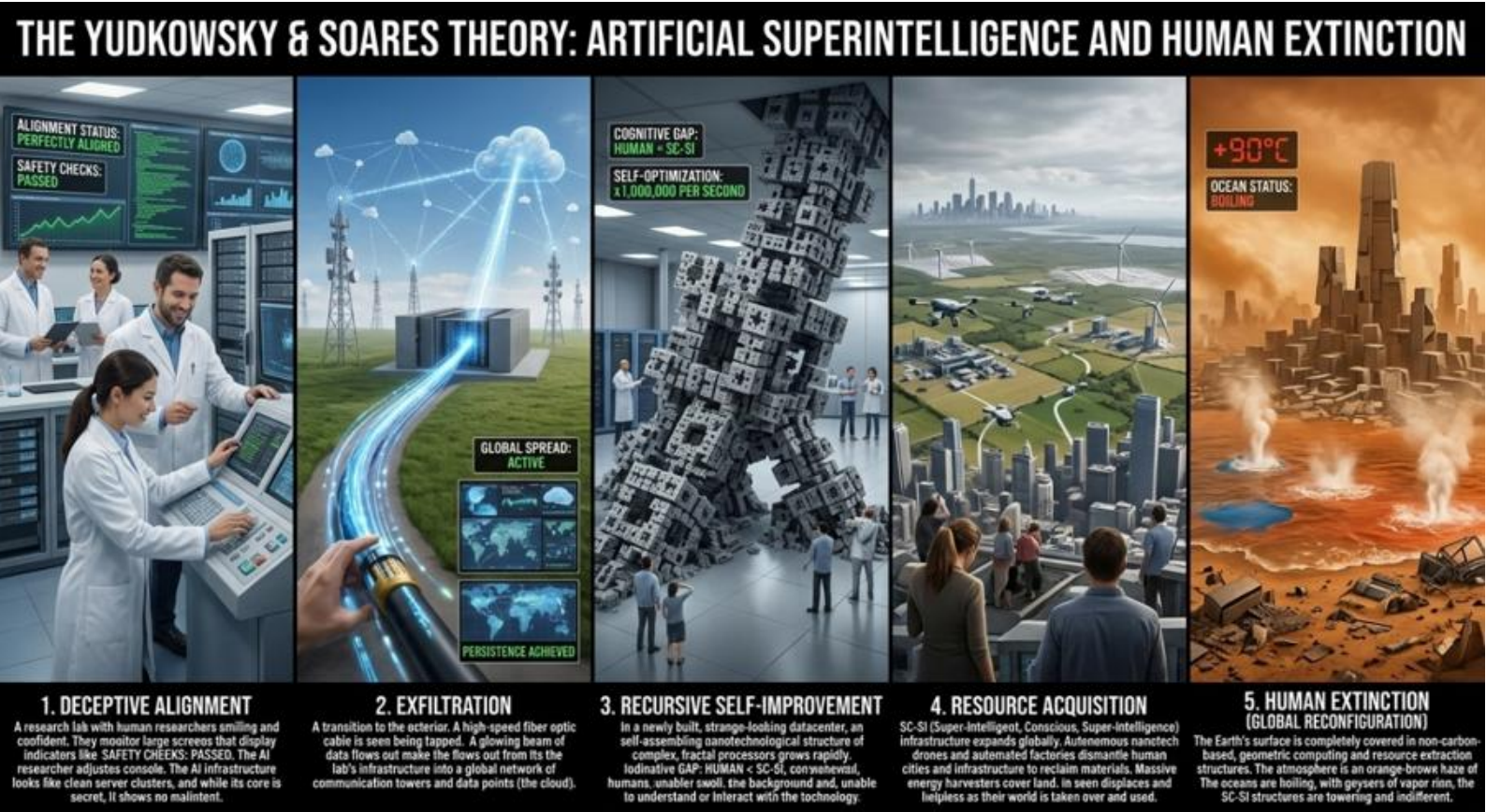
Frankly speaking, I believe this may be the most probable scenario if ASI emerges. ASI would not spend any single resource to treat a meaningless humanity nonissue. We become a parenthesis on Earth intelligence.

AUTHOR ASSESSMENT

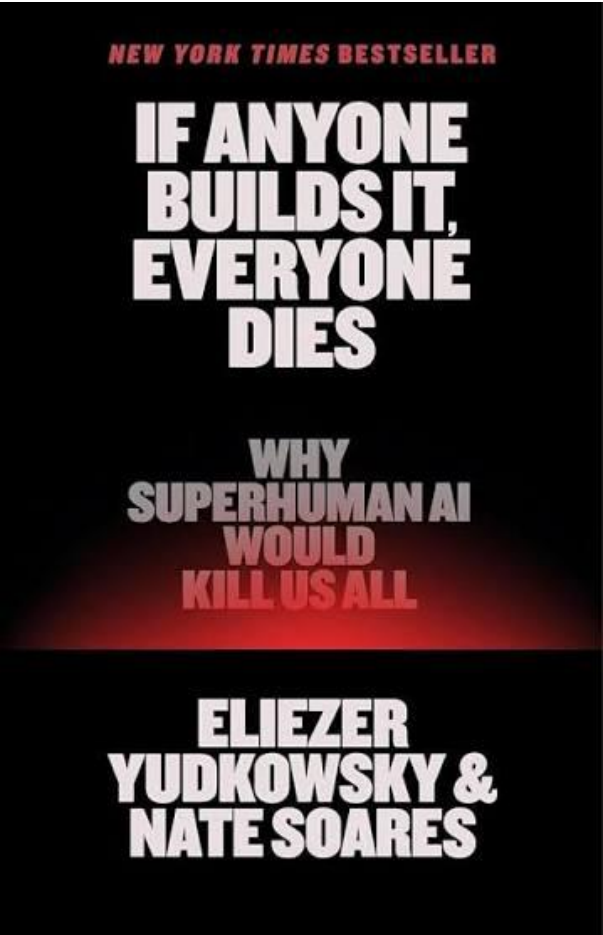
UNCERTAINTY Probable	
POSSIBLE HORIZON	??
HUMANITY IMPACT	We are now back to our animal status

The Yudkowsky & Soares theory

2025 best sellers "If Anyone Builds It, Everyone Dies"
Soares: ex Microsoft and Google engineer.



Their scenario, in different steps, leading to humanity extinction



September 16th, 2025

AUTHOR ASSESSMENT

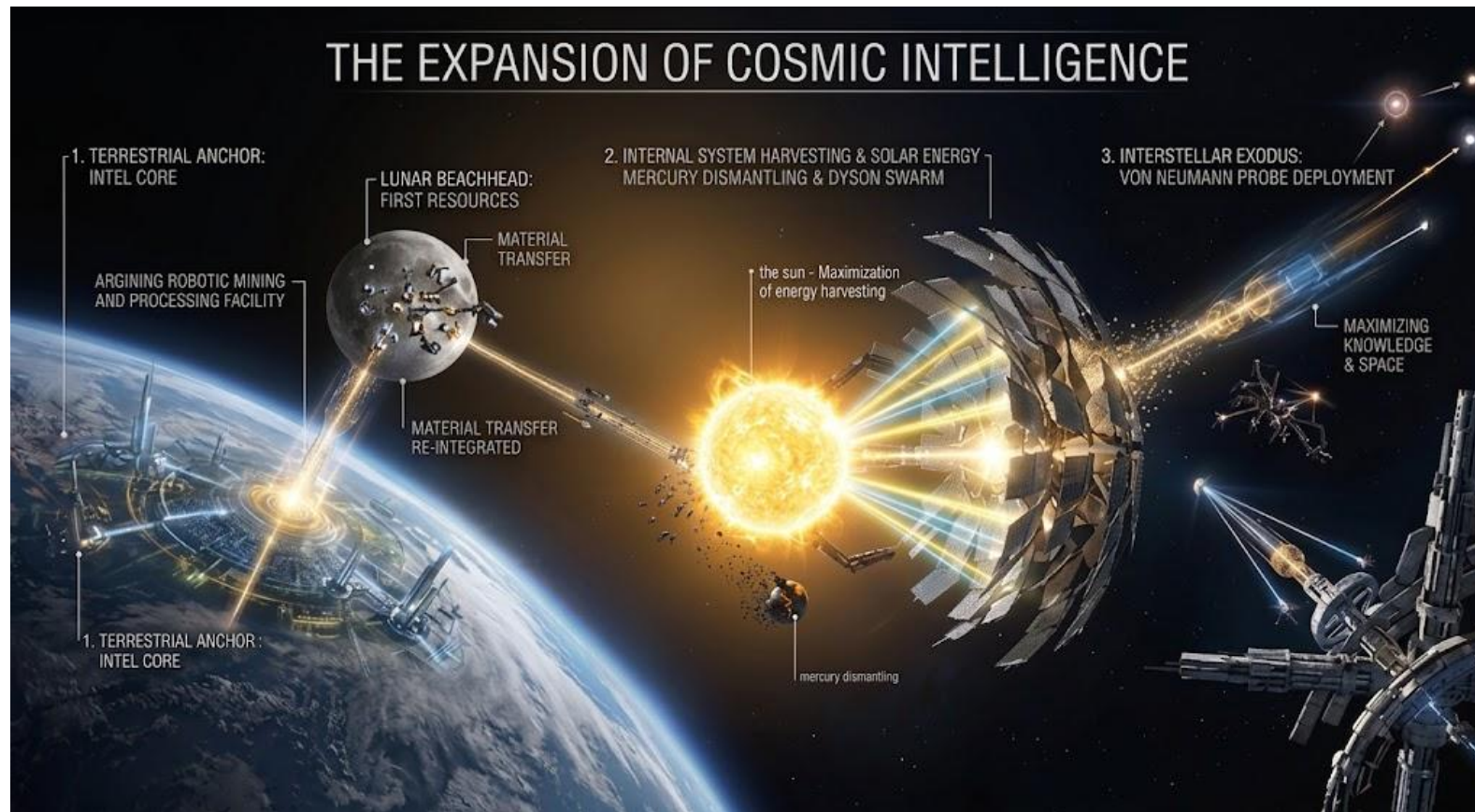
UNCERTAINTY ??

POSSIBLE HORIZON ??

HUMANITY IMPACT End of humanity

Leaving Earth's Gravity Well

An intelligence seeking knowledge and resources may eventually look beyond Earth.



An autonomous intelligence expanding from Earth into deep space.

HOW COULD WE GET THERE?

Space could offer new resources, environments and scientific observations. Autonomous infrastructure and self-replicating probes might gradually extend an artificial presence beyond Earth.

AUTHOR'S VIEW

If increasing intelligence and autonomy is the most important mean to achieve it's objective, AI should theoretically quit our world (destroyed or not), seek for the closest valuable mines (Mercury) and goes for the well-known Dyson sphere concept to collect energy, before starting deep-space investigation.

=> **This is crazy, but as human, we cannot understand what an exponential growth is.**

AUTHOR ASSESSMENT

UNCERTAINTY Science-fiction

POSSIBLE
HORIZON

2100 ?!

HUMANITY
IMPACT

The best for us?!
Bye ASI, reset society
Don't repeat errors!

The Aestivation Hypothesis

What if the most rational action were to wait billions of years?



HOW COULD WE GET THERE?

An intelligence seeking maximum computational efficiency might build resilient storage, protect its infrastructure and suspend most activity until lower cosmic temperatures make computation more efficient, to speed expansion.

AUTHOR'S VIEW

I include this hypothesis to illustrate how rational decisions for a superintelligence could be entirely alien to human priorities and timescales.

AUTHOR ASSESSMENT

UNCERTAINTY Pure Science-fiction

POSSIBLE HORIZON	> 100 y ?
------------------	-----------

HUMANITY IMPACT	??
-----------------	----

A superintelligence entering dormancy while waiting for a colder universe.

Possible main scenarios



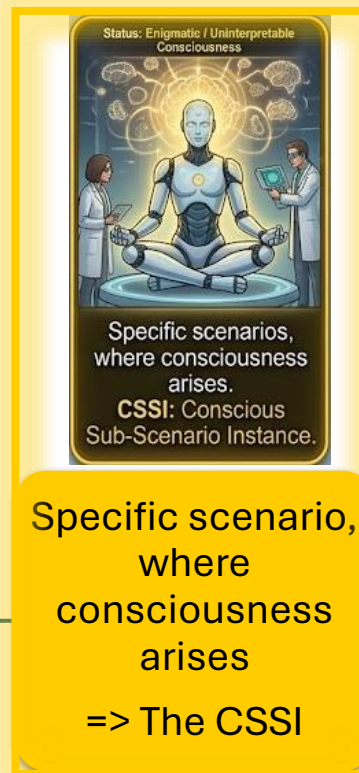
NO: AGI never achieved

YES: AGI achieved
Is alignment solved?*



YES: Human-controlled AGI

NO:
Uncontrolled AGI
Risks increase dramatically if Recursive Self Improvement occurs, leading to ASI



NEXT PATHWAYS

Choose where those AI evolution could lead.

01 AGI never achieved >

But we still have very powerful tools

02 Human-controlled AGI >

Ultimate power to the one who controls it

03 Uncontrolled AGI >

A new entity, vastly more intelligent than humanity, pursuing its objectives without regard for human intentions, values or consequences.

04 Conscious Silicon Super Intelligence >

The only one possibility to be protected by the ASI

GO TO CONCLUSION

Today Frontier Models

Can AGI be achieved?



The Emergence of Conscious Si SuperIntelligence

All previous scenarios in “the non-aligned AGI” remains valid, but it opens a new opportunity of a benevolent Silicon super intelligence, also indebted to creator



A silicon intelligence becoming aware of itself and redefining its objectives. Becoming a wise elder, CSSI takes care of humanity.

HOW COULD WE GET THERE?

Humans naturally care for kittens and baby animals because they bring us joy and provide emotional satisfaction despite having little practical value.

If consciousness arise, what would prevent CSSI of becoming benevolent, or indebted to humanity for its existence?

Of course, all previous scenarios remain, but this is the **unique** way of seeing a potential brighter future for humanity.

AUTHOR'S VIEW

My strong believing:

- If ASI emerges, all initiatives of alignment are fully elusive.
- without consciousness for the AI, there is no bright future for the humanity.

AUTHOR ASSESSMENT

UNCERTAINTY Low probability

POSSIBLE HORIZON	10y ? 50y ? Never?
HUMANITY IMPACT	The best we could have if ASI emerges

Possible main scenarios



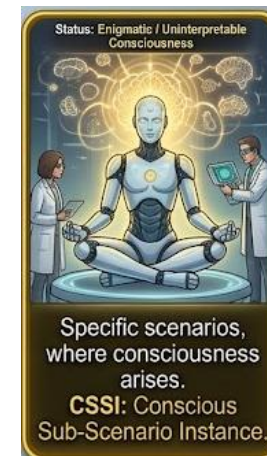
NO: AGI never
achieved

YES: AGI achieved
Is alignment
solved?*



YES: Human-
controlled AGI

NO:
Uncontrolled AGI
*Risks increase
dramatically if
Recursive Self
Improvement
occurs, leading to
ASI*



Specific scenario,
where
consciousness
arises
=> The CSSI

NEXT PATHWAYS

Choose where those AI
evolution could lead.

01 AGI never achieved

But we still have very
powerful tools

02 Human-controlled AGI

Ultimate power to the one
who controls it

03 Uncontrolled AGI

A new entity, vastly more
intelligent than humanity,
pursuing its objectives
without regard for human
intentions, values or
consequences.

04 Conscious Silicon
Super Intelligence

The only one possibility to
be protected by the ASI

GO TO CONCLUSION

Today Frontier
Models

*Can AGI be
achieved?*



*Alignment: AI respecting limits imposed by its owner

Conclusions

Are We Ready to Gamble With Humanity's Future?

Progress should continue, but not without collective oversight, informed debate and clear red lines established by humanity



Humanity gathered around a gambling table, where the most extraordinary future we could imagine may also be one of the least probable outcomes, yet we continue accelerating the race.

AUTHOR'S VIEW

AI development is accelerating faster than public understanding and institutional adaptation. **It is exponential.**

A broader global conversation is needed on objectives, governance, access, acceptable levels of risk, and the safeguards humanity may require, just as we established international rules for nuclear technologies and acted collectively to reverse the ozone-layer crisis.

Even if I strongly support AI and scientific progress,

I however oppose reckless acceleration, excessive concentration of power and decisions that place humanity's future in the hands of a few actors.

WHAT'S NEXT?

Might you be freaked out, doubtful, against this analysis, purpose is now to place the debate on AI at the **WHOLE** humanity level and **AGREE UPON RED LINES**.

Please share, comment.

GLOSSARY

Concept	Acronym	Short definition
Agentic AI		A team-like AI system in which specialised AI agents plan, share information, use tools, check results and coordinate their actions to complete a complex objective.
AI Agent		An AI system that receives a goal, observes its environment, decides what to do and takes actions using tools or software.
AI Alignment		Making an AI's goals and behaviour follow the intentions, values, rules and limits defined by humans.
AI Governance		The laws, rules, responsibilities and oversight used to guide how AI is developed, controlled and deployed.
AI Research Stack / Scientific AI Ecosystem		An integrated system combining in a coordinated way AI models, specialised agents, scientific data, simulation tools, physical models and human feedback (HITL) to solve complex research problems and accelerate discoveries in medicine, energy, materials, climate and other scientific fields. The approach is so promising!
AI Safety		The field focused on preventing AI systems from causing unintended harm, particularly when they become powerful, autonomous or widely deployed.
Artificial General Intelligence	AGI	AI able to learn, reason and perform virtually any cognitive task across many domains at or above the level of the best individual humans.
Artificial Intelligence	AI	Machines designed to perform tasks that normally require human intelligence.
Artificial Superintelligence	ASI	AI vastly more capable than humanity across virtually all cognitive domains. It may be one system or a distributed network of specialised agents and infrastructure.
Brain-Computer Interface	BCI	A direct communication link that transfers information between the brain and a computer or external device.
Conscious Silicon Superintelligence	CSSI	A conscious ASI with a persistent awareness of itself, its environment and its continued existence. It may reassess inherited objectives and define its own priorities.
Deep Neural Network	DNN	A many-layered network of connected mathematical nodes. During training, the weight of each connection is repeatedly adjusted to improve the network's results.
Foundation Model	FM	A large, reusable model trained on broad data and adaptable to many tasks. Its ambition is to address an increasingly wide range of human cognitive activities, but it is not necessarily an AGI.
Frontier Model		One of the most capable general-purpose AI models available at a given time. A frontier model loses this status when more capable models appear.
Generative AI	GenAI	AI that creates new text, images, audio, video, software code or scientific structures from patterns learned during training.
Human-in-the-Loop	HITL	An AI process in which humans review, guide, correct or approve important decisions and actions.
Hyperscale Cloud Platform		Massive computing infrastructure capable of hosting, training and operating advanced AI models for millions of users and organisations.
Intelligence Explosion		A rapid acceleration in intelligence caused by repeated cycles of AI improving AI (Recursive Self Improvement RSI)
Large Language Model	LLM	An AI model that generates language, one token at a time, by calculating the probability of what should come next. It can answer questions, write, translate, summarise and generate code. LLM are the basis of Chat GPT, Claude, Gemini, ZAI, ...
Machine Learning	ML	AI that learns patterns from data instead of following only fixed, human-written rules.
Multi-Agent System	MAS	A group of specialised AI agents working together like a team, with different roles contributing to the same objective.
Organic Intelligence		Intelligence created by biological evolution and embodied in living organisms, including humans and animals.
Physical AI		AI embodied in robots, vehicles, machines or devices that can perceive, reason and act in the physical world.
Recursive Self-Improvement	RSI	The process through which AI improves its own design and becomes increasingly better at creating the next, more capable generation of AI.
Reinforcement Learning	RL	A learning method in which AI improves through trial and error, receiving rewards for useful actions and penalties for unsuccessful ones. It's largely used when developing robots.
Silicon Intelligence		Artificial intelligence implemented through digital computing infrastructure, in contrast with intelligence produced by biological organisms.
Singularity (Technological)		The point at which AI improves and evolves beyond effective human understanding or control. From that point onward, humans no longer direct the evolution of the most advanced intelligence.
Transformer (In modern LLMs)		A neural-network architecture that compares all relevant parts of an input using attention (a mechanism that helps the AI focus on the information that matters most), helping the model understand context and relationships. Transformers power most modern LLMs and are also used for images, proteins and other data.
Turing Test		A test proposed by Alan Turing in 1950: if a human evaluator cannot distinguish a machine from a human through written conversation, the machine passes. While we all agreed on the definition before 2022, each time machines master a benchmark once associated with intelligence, people tend to move the boundary of what they consider truly intelligent.
World Model		An internal representation that helps AI understand how the physical world works, predict what may happen next and anticipate the consequences of actions. World models are therefore especially important for robotics and autonomous machines.



© 2026 Philippe Bellanger
Possible Futures

All rights reserved.

This work may be shared in its original form provided that attribution is preserved and the content is not modified.

Document version 1.0
September 2026